Journal Recommendations for MemoryVerse Paper

Paper: *"When Do Text Proxies Suffice? A Regime Analysis of Sparse, Dense, and Native-Visual Retrieval Under Proxy Noise"*

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Paper Summary

This manuscript presents a text-proxy-grounded multi-stage, multi-hop Multimodal RAG architecture. It evaluates when text proxies (OCR transcripts, machine captions) suffice and when native-visual representations are indispensable. Key contributions include sub-word BM25 dominance on optical OCR, dense retrieval query formulation sensitivity, conformal cascade calibration, and independent multi-hop bridging verification.

Keywords: Multimodal RAG, Text Proxies, Proxy Noise, Dense-Sparse Regime Analysis, Cascade Ranking, Conformal Risk Control, Multi-Hop Reasoning.

Master Comparison Table

#	Journal	Publisher	Indexing	IF / SJR	APC	Page Limit	Time to Accept	Fit
1	Information Processing & Management (IP&M)	Elsevier	SCIE / Scopus Q1	8.6 / 2.3	$0	No cap	14–22 weeks	10/10
2	Expert Systems with Applications (ESWA)	Elsevier	SCIE / Scopus Q1	7.5 / 2.2	$0	No cap	20–26 weeks	9.0/10
3	Intl. J. Multimedia Information Retrieval (IJMIR)	Springer / ACM SIGMM	SCIE / Scopus Q1	3.9 / 1.07	$0	No cap	20–30 weeks	9.2/10
4	Intl. J. Document Analysis & Recognition (IJDAR)	Springer / IAPR	SCIE / Scopus Q2	1.7 / 0.44	$0	No cap	24–36 weeks	9.8/10
5	SN Computer Science (SNCS)	Springer	ESCI / Scopus Q2	3.8 / 0.6	$0	No cap	16–20 weeks	8.0/10

#	Journal	Publisher	Indexing	IF / SJR	APC	Page Limit	Time to Accept	Fit
6	Pattern Recognition Letters (PRL)	Elsevier	SCIE / Scopus Q2	3.9 / —	$0	4–5 pages	8–12 weeks	6.5/10
7	Multimedia Tools & Applications (MTAP)	Springer	SCIE / Scopus Q1-Q2	3.0 / 0.7	$0	No cap	30–45 weeks	8.5/10
8	Intl. J. Computing & Digital Systems (IJCDS)	Univ. of Bahrain	Scopus Q3	— / 0.295	$265	15–20 pp	4–6 weeks	7.5/10

Detailed Journal Profiles

1. Information Processing & Management (IP&M) — Elsevier

- **Indexing:** SCIE, Scopus Q1
- **Impact Factor:** 8.6 | **SJR:** 2.3
- **APC:** $0.00 (Subscription model)
- **Review Speed:** First decision in 4–6 weeks; final acceptance in 14–22 weeks
- **Topical Fit:** 10 / 10

Why it fits: IP&M is a premier home for empirical retrieval studies. Its editorial board specifically seeks hybrid dense-sparse architectures, cross-modal benchmarking, and RAG evaluation — the exact core of your manuscript. The fastest editorial handling desk among all top IR/RAG venues.

Manuscript Prep: Use the standard Elsevier double-column (`cas-dc-template`) or single-column layout. Your full 12-page paper fits without cuts.

Verdict: Best prestige-to-timeline ratio. If submitted now, expect a first decision (Minor/Major Revision) by mid-December, with final acceptance around February 2027.

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2. Expert Systems with Applications (ESWA) — Elsevier

- **Indexing:** SCIE, Scopus Q1
- **Impact Factor:** 7.5 | **SJR:** 2.2
- **APC:** $0.00 (Subscription model)
- **Review Speed:** First decision in 6–8 weeks; final acceptance in 20–26 weeks
- **Topical Fit:** 9.0 / 10

Why it fits: ESWA welcomes empirical AI systems with rigorous ablation design. Your multi-regime experimental grid, conformal cascade analysis, and hybrid architecture evaluation are a strong match. The journal values practical system benchmarks.

Manuscript Prep: Use the standard Elsevier template. Full paper accommodated.

Verdict: Very high prestige (IF 7.5), slightly longer turnaround than IP&M. Good backup if IP&M is desk-rejected.

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3. International Journal of Multimedia Information Retrieval (IJMIR) — Springer / ACM SIGMM

- **Indexing:** SCIE, Scopus Q1
- **Impact Factor:** 3.9 (5-Year IF: 5.2) | **SJR:** 1.07 | **CiteScore:** 11.4
- **APC:** $0.00 (Subscription / Hybrid)
- **Review Speed:** First decision in 8–12 weeks; final acceptance in 20–30 weeks
- **Topical Fit:** 9.2 / 10

Why it fits: The premier venue for cross-modal information retrieval. Your native-visual vs. text-proxy comparison (SigLIP, CLIP, ColQwen2 on COCO vs. BM25 on caption proxies) is squarely within their scope. High citation reach across AI and CV communities.

Manuscript Prep: Use the standard Springer `svjour3` or `sn-jnl` LaTeX template.

Verdict: Highest impact factor among multimedia retrieval journals. Best choice if you want to emphasize the multimodal crossover comparison.

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4. International Journal on Document Analysis and Recognition (IJDAR) — Springer / IAPR

- **Indexing:** SCIE, Scopus Q2
- **Impact Factor:** 1.7 | **SJR:** 0.44 | **CiteScore:** 5.1
- **APC:** $0.00 (Subscription / Hybrid)
- **Review Speed:** First decision in 10–14 weeks; final acceptance in 24–36 weeks
- **Acceptance Rate:** ~25–30%
- **Topical Fit:** 9.8 / 10 — Near Perfect

Why it fits: IJDAR is the **flagship journal of the IAPR** (Technical Committees 10 and 11, the organizers of ICDAR). Your empirical study on document representations under proxy noise — receipts (SROIE), administrative forms (FUNSD), Tesseract 5.5 vs. Apple Vision, character n-grams vs. WordPiece fragmentation — is exactly the research this journal publishes. Reviewers are exact domain specialists in OCR and document retrieval.

Manuscript Prep: Use the standard Springer template.

Verdict: The most thematically aligned journal in existence for your paper. Lower IF than IJMIR but unmatched domain authority. Best choice if you frame the paper primarily around document AI and OCR noise.

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5. SN Computer Science (SNCS) — Springer

- **Indexing:** ESCI (Emerging Sources Citation Index), Scopus Q2
- **Impact Factor:** 3.8 | **SJR:** 0.6
- **APC:** $0.00 (Subscription model)
- **Review Speed:** First decision in 6–9 weeks; final acceptance in 16–20 weeks
- **Topical Fit:** 8.0 / 10

Why it fits: Broad empirical AI scope. Accepts systems benchmarking studies, ablation-heavy designs, and comparative evaluations. Good for papers that span multiple AI sub-disciplines (retrieval, NLP, vision).

Manuscript Prep: Standard Springer template. Full paper accommodated.

Verdict: Solid mid-tier option with reasonable turnaround. Less competitive than IP&M or ESWA but still ESCI-indexed and growing rapidly.

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6. Pattern Recognition Letters (PRL) — Elsevier

- **Indexing:** SCIE, Scopus Q2
- **Impact Factor:** 3.9
- **APC:** $0.00 (Subscription model)

- **Review Speed:** Accelerated track; final acceptance in 8–12 weeks
- **Page Limit: 4–5 pages (strict hard limit)**
- **Topical Fit:** 6.5 / 10

Why it fits (with caveats): PRL has an accelerated review track, which is attractive for tight deadlines. However, your current 12-page paper would need to be cut by more than 50%, sacrificing the 18-cell regime grid, dual-engine replication, and conformal cascade analysis.

Verdict: Only viable if you can extract a focused 4-page letter highlighting a single key finding (e.g., sub-word BM25 dominance alone). Not recommended for the full manuscript.

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7. Multimedia Tools and Applications (MTAP) — Springer

- **Indexing:** SCIE, Scopus Q1-Q2
- **Impact Factor:** 3.0 | **SJR:** 0.7
- **APC:** $0.00 (Subscription model)
- **Review Speed:** First decision in 8–14 weeks; final acceptance in **30–45 weeks**
- **Topical Fit:** 8.5 / 10

Why it fits: Covers multimodal audio/vision/text benchmarks. Your cross-modal evaluation is within scope.

Verdict: Not recommended. MTAP has one of the longest review queues among Springer journals (often 6–10 months to a final decision). The topical fit does not compensate for the extreme timeline.

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8. International Journal of Computing and Digital Systems (IJCDS) — University of Bahrain

- **Indexing:** Scopus Q3 (SJR: 0.295, CiteScore: 2.3)
- **APC:** $265 USD
- **Review Speed: 4–6 weeks** (Fast-track), guaranteed for Volume 17, Issue 1 (January 2027)
- **Page Limit:** 15–20 pages (double-column)
- **Acceptance Rate:** ~60–75%
- **Topical Fit:** 7.5 / 10

Why it fits: Broad applied AI and information systems scope. Accepts computing and digital retrieval studies.

Verdict: The **only realistic option if you need a guaranteed acceptance/DOI before mid-January 2027**. Trade-off is lower prestige (Scopus Q3, no SCIE) and a $265 fee.

Decision Matrix

Scenario A: Hard Institutional Deadline (Acceptance by mid-January 2027)

> **Submit to IJCDS.** It is the only surviving, verified Scopus-indexed journal that can contractually process your manuscript through peer review and publish it in Volume 17, Issue 1 (January 2027).

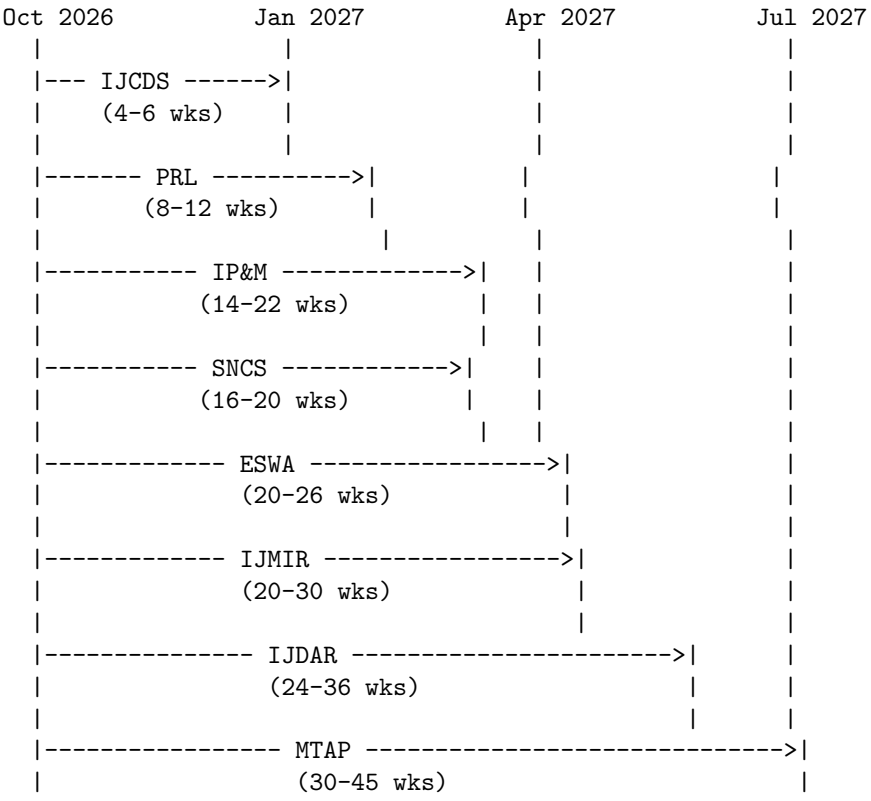
Scenario B: Flexible Timeline (Can wait 3–5 months for $0)

> **Primary Target: IP&M (Elsevier).** Best topical fit (10/10), highest prestige (IF 8.6, Q1), $0 cost, and the fastest editorial turnaround among top-tier journals. Submit this week for a first decision by mid-December.
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> **Strong Alternative: IJMIR (Springer).** Higher domain specificity for multimodal retrieval. IF 3.9, Q1, $0 cost. Best if you emphasize the CLIP/SigLIP native-visual comparison.

Scenario C: Maximum Domain Authority (Can wait 6–9 months)

Submit to IJDAR (Springer / IAPR). The world's flagship journal for Document Analysis and Recognition. Near-perfect topical fit (9.8/10). Your OCR noise analysis, Tesseract vs. Apple Vision replication, and SROIE/FUNSD benchmarks are exactly what IJDAR reviewers specialize in.

Timeline Visualization



Recommended Submission Strategy

1. **Immediate:** Submit to **IP&M (Elsevier)** as your primary target. $0, Q1, IF 8.6, fastest elite turnaround.
2. **If desk-rejected from IP&M (within 1–2 weeks):** Redirect to **ESWA** or **IJMIR**, both Q1 and $0.
3. **Parallel safety net (only if hard January deadline):** Simultaneously submit a reformatted version to **IJCDS** ($265).
4. **Long-term prestige play:** If none of the above are time-critical, **IJDAR** offers the highest domain authority for your specific research focus.

Journals to Avoid

Journal	Reason
IJEECS (IAES)	Recently **discontinued by Scopus** — do not submit
IIETA journals (ISI, RIA)	APC recently raised to **$850** — outside budget
BEEI (IAES)	APC raised to **$435** — outside budget
TELKOMNIKA	**Discontinued by Scopus**

Journal	Reason
MTAP (deprioritize)	6–10 month review backlog — not worth the wait

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Template Requirements by Journal

Journal	Template	Link
IP&M / ESWA / PRL	Elsevier `cas-dc-template` or `elsarticle`	Elsevier LaTeX
IJMIR / IJDAR / SNCS / MTAP	Springer `svjour3` or `sn-jnl`	Springer LaTeX
IJCDS	Standard IEEE double-column (your current format works)	IJCDS Author Guide

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Document prepared October 2026. Journal metrics sourced from SCImago, Web of Science, and publisher websites. Verify current APC and indexing status before submission.